

Esther's Courageous Stand: For Such a Time as This

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 44 of 60

Order: dannyshalom.etsy.com | Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com | WhatsApp:
+971525950021

Scene 2

[PICTURE: The magnificent Persian palace of Susa with towering columns and hanging gardens. King Xerxes sits on an elevated golden throne, looking troubled and displeased. Courtiers whisper nervously in the background. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

King Xerxes ruled from his throne in the citadel of Susa. After Queen Vashti refused to appear at his banquet, the king was furious and banished her. His advisors suggested a search throughout all provinces for a new queen — someone beautiful, wise, and worthy of the royal crown.

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(Nigus AHishweros kab zifanu ab gimbi Susa yigez'i nebere. Nigisti Washti ab digsu kitqerib mis abeyet, nigus teqoTi'u segoga. Amakhertu ab kulen awrajat Hadas nigisti kidelyu Hasab aqrebu — tsibiqti, Tibebenyain ninay nigusawi zewdi zibeqi'in.)

Scene 3

[PICTURE: Mordecai speaking privately with young Esther, his hand on her shoulder, his face serious and caring. He speaks urgently while she listens intently. A window shows Persian soldiers gathering young women outside. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When the king's decree reached their city, Mordecai knew Esther would be taken to the palace. He pulled her aside and spoke urgently: "You must not reveal your Jewish identity to anyone. Keep our people's heritage hidden in your heart, but never forget who you truly are — a daughter of the God of Abraham."

[illegible]

(Awaj nigus nab ketema'om mis bets'He, Mordeke Ester nab beyte-mengisti kem tiwsed feleThe. Felyu "nay Ayhud mennetki nimanum aytgiletsi. Wirsha hizibna ab libki Hab'iyu, gin men mukhanki aytiresii — gual Amlak Abrham ikhi" bihitsuTs negeraa.)

Scene 4

[PICTURE: Esther among many beautiful young women in the palace women's quarters. She stands out with her quiet grace and humility. A kind eunuch named Hegai presents her with special oils and foods. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Esther was taken to the palace along with many other young women from across the empire. Hegai, the keeper of the women, was immediately impressed by her grace and character. He provided her with the best beauty treatments and seven chosen maids. Yet Esther remained humble, winning favor not through arrogance but through genuine kindness.

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(Ester kab milu'e mengisti mis buzuHat kal'ot men'eseyat anisti nab beyte-mengisti tewsedet. Hege Halawi anisti bitsega'an bahriyatan biqits'bet temeseTe. Zibeletse nay tsibaqe kinikiniin shew'ate zitemerTsa geredatin aqrebela. Ester gin tiHut koyna, biHaqenya lewhat'mber bit'i'bit moges rekhebet.)

Scene 5

[PICTURE: King Xerxes placing a royal crown on Esther's head in a grand throne room. His face shows genuine admiration and joy. Esther looks dignified yet humble, wearing beautiful royal robes. Courtiers watch in amazement. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Esther's turn came to appear before the king, she asked for nothing more than what Hegai advised. The king was captivated — not merely by her beauty, but by her wisdom and grace. He set the royal crown upon her head, declaring her queen above all others. A great banquet was held in her honor throughout the empire.

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(Gize Ester ab qidmi nigus kitqerib mis bets'He, Hege kab zimekera nil'ali ayHatetetin. Nigus temarekhe — bitsibaqe'a Teray zeyikone biTibebain tsega'ain. Nigusawit zewdi ab ri'isa aqemiTu kab kulen nil'ali nigisti aweja. Abi digsi ab milu'e mengisti nikhbra tekayede.)

Scene 6

[PICTURE: Mordecai sitting faithfully at the palace gate day after day, wearing simple Jewish clothing. He overhears two guards whispering a plot against the king. His face shows alertness and concern. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Mordecai faithfully sat at the king's gate each day, watching over Esther from afar. One day, he overheard two royal guards — Bigthana and Teresh — plotting to assassinate King Xerxes. Mordecai immediately reported the conspiracy through Esther, and the traitors were executed. The event was recorded in the royal chronicles, though Mordecai received no reward.

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(Mordeke nefsi wekef me'alti ab dege nigus bi'iminnnet kof ilu ni'Ester birHuq yiHilwa nebere. Hade me'alti kilte nay nigus Halewti — Bigtana'n Teresh'n — ninigus AHishweros kiqetl'wo kiwTenu sem'e. Mordeke biqits'bet bi'Ester abilu neti widit Habere, itom keda'at dima teqetlu. Ab nay nigusawi zena me'alti tetsaHfe, Mordeke gin shilmata aytewahbon.)

Scene 7

[PICTURE: Haman, a proud and arrogant official in luxurious robes, walking through the palace gate. All people bow before him except Mordecai who stands upright with quiet dignity. Haman's face burns with rage. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After these events, King Xerxes elevated Haman the Agagite to the highest position in the empire. All royal officials were commanded to bow before him. But Mordecai refused to kneel — not out of stubbornness, but because as a Jew, he would bow only before God. Haman noticed this act of defiance, and fury consumed his heart.

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(DiHri'zi fits'ametata nigus AHishweros niHaman Agagawi nab'ta zile'alet silTan ab'ta mengisti a'ibeyoo. Kulom nay nigus sebesilTan ab qidmi'u kisigdu te'azezu. Mordeke gin kisged abeye — bitri zeykone kem Ayhudawi ni'Amlak Teray sile zisged. Haman nezi tsere-ti'izaz ri'iyu quTi'a libu mel'o.)

Scene 8

[PICTURE: Haman in a dark room casting lots (Pur dice) on a table, his face twisted with hatred and scheming. Shadows emphasize his evil intentions. A map of the Persian Empire hangs on the wall behind him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Haman's hatred grew beyond one man. He learned Mordecai was Jewish, and decided that punishing one person was not enough — he would destroy all the Jews in the entire Persian Empire. He cast lots, called "Pur," to determine the date for this massacre. The lot fell on the twelfth month, Adar, giving him nearly a year to execute his genocidal plan.

[illegible]

(Tsili'i Haman kab Hade seb Halifu abeye. Mordeke Ayhudawi mukhanu mis feleThe, niHade seb miqTs'a'i ayi'akilin ilu wesene — ab milu'e nay Faris mengisti nikulum Ayhud keTif'i deleye. Neti nay Tif'at me'alti nimwisian "Pur" zibhal itsHa derbeye. ItsHa ab mebel aserte kilte werHi Adar wedeqe, neti nay hizbi-tsintet wiTnu nimgibar kisab Hade amet habe.)

Scene 9

[PICTURE: Haman kneeling before King Xerxes, presenting a scroll with his decree. He offers bags of silver, looking persuasive and cunning. The king looks thoughtful, holding his royal ring. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Haman approached the king with poisonous words: "There is a certain people scattered throughout your kingdom whose customs differ from all others. They do not obey the king's laws. It is not in your interest to tolerate them." He offered ten thousand talents of silver to finance their destruction. The king, not knowing these were Esther's people, gave Haman his signet ring to seal the decree.

[illegible]

(Haman bimerzam qalat nab nigus qerebe: "Ab milu'e mengistikha zitebetenu limiditathom kab kulu zitefeleye hizbi alo. Higi nigus ayi'izezun. Kittsawerom ni'akha ayTeqimin." NiTif'atom nimmiwal aserte shiH talent birur aqrebe. Nigus izi'atom nay Ester hizbi mukhnom keyfeleThe neti awaj nimHitam nay maHtem qelebetu niHaman habo.)

Scene 10

[PICTURE: Throughout the city of Susa, Jewish families weep and mourn in the streets. Mordecai tears his clothes and puts on sackcloth and ashes, crying out in grief at the palace gate. The city is in confusion and despair. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The decree was dispatched to every province: on the thirteenth day of Adar, all Jews — young and old, women and children — were to be destroyed. When Mordecai learned of the edict, he tore his clothes, dressed in sackcloth and ashes, and went into the city crying with a loud and bitter cry. Throughout the empire, Jews mourned with fasting, weeping, and wailing.

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(Awaj nab kulen awrajat tela'ike: ab mebel aserte seleste me'alti Adar kulom Ayhud — men'ese'y'n aregawiyen'n anistin qol'un — kiTef'u neberom. Mordeke neti awaj mis feleThe kidanu qedede, sheHani lebisu biHamukshiti tesheifinu bi'awta'n meriir'n bikhyat nab ketema wetse. Ab milu'e mengisti Ayhud bitsom'n bikhyat'n waywaytan Hazenu.)

Scene 11

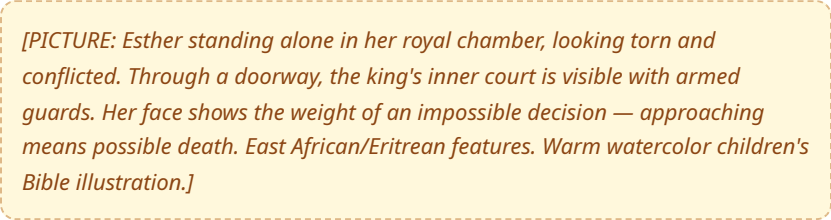
[PICTURE: Esther's maid Hathak going back and forth between Esther in her royal chambers and Mordecai at the gate, carrying messages. Esther looks distressed upon receiving the news, holding a copy of the decree. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Esther's maids reported that Mordecai was in sackcloth at the gate, she was deeply distressed. She sent her servant Hathak to learn why. Mordecai gave him a copy of the decree and urged him to tell Esther she must go before the king to plead for her people's lives. The weight of an entire nation's survival now rested upon her shoulders.

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(Geredat Ester Mordeke sheHani lebisu ab dege kem zelo mis negeraa, azya shaqlet.
 Silemintay mukhanu kifeliT agelgali'a Hatak sededet. Mordeke qidaH nay'ti awaj hibu
 Ester nihiyivet hizba kitlimin ab qidmi nigus kitqerib kem zelewa nikihnegra lemenoo.
 Hiji nay milu'e hizbi diHnet ab li'ili menkuba tse'ane.)

Scene 12



Esther sent word back to Mordecai explaining her impossible dilemma: "Anyone who approaches the king in the inner court without being summoned faces death — unless the king extends his golden scepter. I have not been called to the king in thirty days." The law was absolute. Even the queen could be executed for this violation. Fear gripped her heart.

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(Ester zeykhe'al mircha'a kitgelits niMordeke mel'ikhti sededet: "Zikhone seb keyitetsewi'u nab wishtawi adarash nigus ziqerib mot yits'beyoo — nigus werqawi betri zeyzergH di'a. Selasa me'alti koynu nab nigus keyitetsewa'iku." Higi fits'um nebere. Nigisti'wun bezi TiHset kitqitel tikhil neberet. FirHi liba Hazoo.)

Scene 13

[PICTURE: Mordecai standing at the gate with fierce determination, speaking his famous words through a messenger. His eyes burn with prophetic conviction. The words "For such a time as this" seem to echo in the air around him. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Mordecai's response was powerful and prophetic: "Do not think that because you are in the king's palace you alone will escape. If you remain silent at this time, relief and deliverance will arise for the Jews from another place, but you and your father's family will perish. And who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?" These words pierced Esther's soul — God had placed her exactly where she needed to be.

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(Melsi Mordeke Hayal'n nebiyaw'n nebere: "Ab beyte-mengisti sile zelokhi niski beynkhi kitdiHni ikhi aytiHsebi. Ab'zi gize'zi siq intbelki Hagez'n midHan'n ni'Ayhud kab kal'e bota kimets'i'yu, niskin beyt abokhin gin kitTef'u ikhum. Nikemzi zi'amesele gize nab'za mengisti metsi'ikhi tikoni men yifeliT?" Izi qalat ninefsi Ester wega'a — Amlak ab'ti kitkewin zedilya bota bilikii aqemiTuwa nebere.)

Scene 14

[PICTURE: Esther on her knees in prayer, surrounded by her maids who also pray and fast. The room is dimly lit with a sense of spiritual warfare and deep communion with God. Her face shows both anguish and growing resolve. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Esther's resolve hardened into holy courage. She sent her final message to Mordecai: "Go, gather all the Jews in Susa, and fast for me. Do not eat or drink for three days, night or day. I and my maids will fast likewise. Then I will go to the king, though it is against the law. And if I perish, I perish." With these words, Esther chose faith over fear, duty over self-preservation.

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(Qorats'net Ester nab qidus jigninnet teqeyere. Nab Mordeke nay meweda'eta mel'ikhta sededet: "Kid nikiulom ab Susa zelew Ayhud akibka ni'ay tsiumu. Seleste me'alti leytin qetirin aytibl'u aytisteyu. Ane'n geredateyn kem'u kintsewim ina. Shi'u higi ziTiHis'kwa intekone nab nigus kikeyd'ye. InteTefi'iku Tefi'iku." Bezi qalat Ester kab firHi immnet, kab midiHan ri'isi gibu'e meretset.)

Scene 15

[PICTURE: After three days, Esther dressed in her finest royal robes, standing at the entrance to the inner court. She takes a deep breath, her face showing courage mixed with vulnerability. Guards look on with surprise. The golden throne room stretches before her. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After three days of fasting and prayer, Esther put on her royal robes. Her body was weak from fasting, but her spirit was strengthened by God. She walked toward the inner court of the king's palace — each step an act of faith, each heartbeat a prayer. The guards watched in astonishment as the queen approached uninvited, knowing the law that condemned such boldness.

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(DiHri seleste me'alti tsom'n tselot'n Ester nigusawi khidawinita lebiset. Akalata bitsom dikhami nebere gin menfesa bi'Amlak Haylu rekhebe. Nab wishtawi adarash beyte-mengisti nigus abila tegwa'izet — nefsi wekef sigumti nay imnet tegbar, nefsi wekef hirmet libi tselot. Halewti nigisti keyite'ademmet kitqerib ri'yom bimigiram te'azebu, kemzi aynet difret zikunin higi feliTom.)

Scene 16

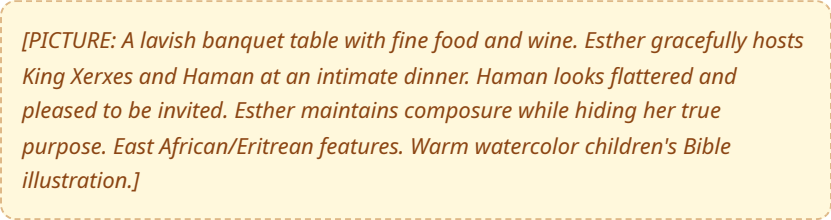
[PICTURE: King Xerxes on his throne extending his golden scepter toward Esther with a warm smile. Esther reaches out to touch the tip of the scepter, relief and gratitude flooding her face. The court breathes a collective sigh of relief. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The moment Esther appeared in the inner court, the king saw her and his heart was moved. God's invisible hand was at work. Xerxes extended his golden scepter toward her — the sign of life and acceptance. "What is your request, Queen Esther?" he asked warmly. "Even up to half the kingdom, it will be given to you." God had granted her favor at the critical moment.

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(Ester ab wishtawi adarash mis tera'yet, nigus ri'iu libu teneqneqe. Zeyir'e id Amlak yiseriH nebere. AHishweros werqawi betru nab'a zergiHe — nay hiyiwet'n miqbal'n milikiti. "HiTokhi intay'yu nigisti Ester?" bimuqet Hateta. "Firqi mengisti'wun intekone kiwehabeki'yu." Amlak ab'ti wesani himot moges haba.)

Scene 17

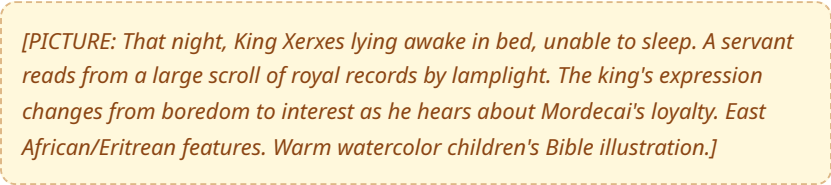


Rather than blurting out her request in desperation, Esther demonstrated strategic wisdom. She invited the king and Haman to a private banquet she had prepared. At the feast, the king again asked her desire. But Esther — patient and calculating — asked only that they return tomorrow for a second banquet, where she would reveal her petition. She was building anticipation, trusting God's perfect timing.

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(HiTo'a bihiwket kab mizrab Ester strategiyawi Tibeb ar'ayet. Ninigus'n niHaman'n nab zedalewetonatawi digsi ademet'om. Ab'ti digsi nigus kem biHadish dileta Hateta. Ester gin — te'agasit'n siHib'n — tsbaH nikal'ay digsi kimlesu Teray Hatetet, ab'u HiTo'a kiteqrib mukhana negeretom. Titsbit kithants biFits'um gize Amlak ti'amin neberet.)

Scene 18



That night, God worked behind the scenes in a remarkable way. The king could not sleep. He ordered the royal chronicles to be read to him. "By chance" — though nothing is chance with God — the servant read the account of Mordecai saving the king's life from the assassination plot. "What honor was given to Mordecai for this?" the king asked. "Nothing was done for him," they replied. God's hidden hand was setting the stage.

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(Bi'u leyti Amlak bidiHri medrekh bizideniqi agebab serHe. Nigus diqas se'ane. Nay nigusawi zena me'alti kinbebulu azeze. "Bi'agatami" — mis Amlak agatami zibhal'kwa zeyhalewe — agelgali Mordeke hiyiwet nigus kab'ti nay qitlet widit kem zidiHane anbebe. "NiMordeke bisenki'zi intay khibri tewahibo?" Hatete nigus. "Hanti'wun aytegeberelun" ilom melesu. Siwir id Amlak medrekh yiser'i nebere.)

Scene 19

[PICTURE: Haman looking humiliated and horrified as he leads Mordecai on a royal horse through the city streets, proclaiming Mordecai's honor. People watch and cheer for Mordecai while Haman's face burns with shame. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The next morning, Haman arrived at the palace early — planning to ask the king to hang Mordecai. But before he could speak, the king asked: "What should be done for the man the king delights to honor?" Haman, assuming it was about himself, described a lavish public parade. The king replied: "Do exactly that for Mordecai the Jew." The irony was devastating — Haman was forced to publicly honor the very man he planned to destroy.

[illegible]

(NitsibiHitu tsbaH Haman niMordeke kiseqilo kiHatit angihu nab beyte-mengisti metse. Gin keyitezerebe nigus "Nigus kekhibro zidelyo seb intay kigeberelu alewo?" Hatetoo. Haman biza'iba ri'isu mukhanu bimisHasab abi nay hizbi selfi getetse. Nigus "Bilik'i kem'u niMordeke Ayhudawi giberelu" ilu melese. Mistini'u zebitsiH nebere — Haman neti keTif'o ziHasebo seb biwegi'i kekhibir tegedede.)

Scene 21

[PICTURE: Haman fallen on the couch where Esther reclines, begging for his life. The king returns from the garden in rage. Guards move to cover Haman's face, sealing his fate. The scene shows justice being served. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The king stormed out to the palace garden in rage. Haman, terrified, fell on the couch where Esther reclined, begging for mercy. When the king returned and saw this, his anger intensified. A servant informed him that Haman had built gallows seventy-five feet high intended for Mordecai. "Hang him on it!" the king commanded. The very instrument of death Haman prepared for the righteous was turned upon himself — a powerful lesson in divine justice.

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(Nigus biquTi'a nab nay beyte-mengisti atakhilti wetse. Haman bifirHi ab'ti Ester zineberetoar'at wedeqe miHret liminu. Nigus temelisu nezi mis re'aye quTi'a'u wesekhe. Hade agelgali Haman niMordeke seb'an Hamushtein igri ziqumetu mesqelya kem ziserHe Haberoo. "Ab'u siqelu!" azeze nigus. Iti Haman nitsadiq zidalewo nay mot mesarHi ab li'ili ri'isu temelese — nay melekotawi fitiHi Hayal timihirti.)

Scene 22

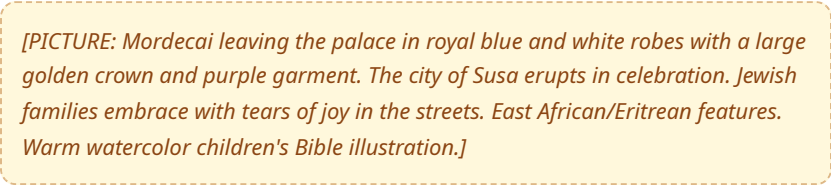
[PICTURE: Esther weeping at the king's feet, pleading again. The king extends his scepter once more. Mordecai stands nearby in royal robes and a signet ring, now elevated to Haman's former position. A new decree is being written. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

But Esther's work was not finished. Though Haman was dead, his decree of destruction still stood — Persian law could not be revoked. Esther again risked approaching the king, weeping at his feet, begging him to find a way to save her people. The king gave Mordecai his signet ring and authority to write a new decree: the Jews would be permitted to defend themselves against any who attacked them.

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(Gin sirah Ester aytewide'an. Haman'kwa zimote nay Tif'at awaju gin yiqitsil nebere — higi Faris kisrez aykhilin'yu. Ester kem biHadish nab nigus qeriba ab a'igaru wediqa hizba nay midiHan mendedi kirekib lemeneto bibikhyat. Nigus niMordeke nay maHtem qelebetu'n silTan'n hibu hadish awaj kitsHif feqede: Ayhud zikhone ziTiq'om ninebsom kikilakrelu tefeqedelom.)

Scene 23

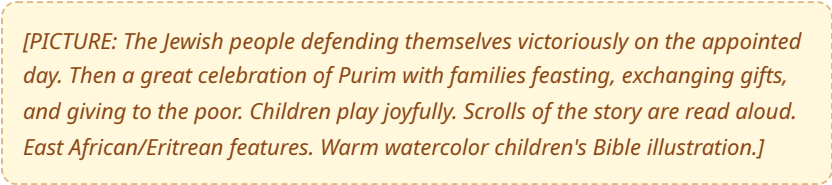


Mordecai left the king's presence wearing royal garments of blue and white, with a great golden crown and a purple robe. The city of Susa erupted in shouts of joy! For the Jews, there was light and gladness, joy and honor. In every province where the new decree arrived, there was celebration and feasting. Many people of other nationalities even identified with the Jews, recognizing that God was with them.

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(Mordeke semayaw'n tsa'ida'n nay nigusawi khidawiniti lebisu mis abay werqawit zewid'n hibri lila khidan'n kab qidmi nigus wetse. Ketema Susa binay Hagos awiyat tenqeTqeTe! Ni'Ayhud birhan'n Hagos'n taHguas'n khibir'n neberom. Ab nefsi wekef awraja iti Hadish awaj zibets'He ab'al'n digis'n nebere. BuzuHat kab kal'ot hizibitat Amlak misa'om kem zelo feliTom mis Ayhud teleleyu.)

Scene 24



When the thirteenth day of Adar arrived — the day Haman had chosen for destruction — the tables were completely turned. The Jews defended themselves and overcame their enemies. Afterward, Mordecai and Esther established the feast of Purim, named after the "Pur" (lot) Haman had cast. Every year, Jews would remember how God turned their mourning into dancing, their sorrow into celebration, and their death sentence into deliverance.

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(Mebel aserte seleste me'alti Adar mis bets'He — Haman niTif'at zimeretso me'alti — kunetat bimilu'u tegelibeTe. Ayhud ninebsom tekhelakhelu nitsela'itom dima se'aru. DiHri'u Mordeke'n Ester'n nay Purim be'al aqomu, Haman biziderbeyoo "Pur" (itsHa) tesemye. Nefsi wekef amet Ayhud Amlak Hazenom nab sa'isa'it, guahom nab ab'al, nay mot firdom nab midiHan kem ziqeyero kizikuru neberom.)

Scene 25

[PICTURE: Esther and Mordecai standing together on a palace balcony overlooking the peaceful empire. Esther wears her crown with quiet dignity. Mordecai stands beside her as second-in-command. Below, diverse families live in harmony. A subtle divine light shines from above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Mordecai became second only to King Xerxes, using his power to seek the welfare of all his people. Esther remained queen — a woman whose courage changed history. Though God's name is never directly mentioned in the Book of Esther, His fingerprints are everywhere: in the "coincidence" of Esther's crown, in the king's sleepless night, in the perfect timing of every event. God is always working, even when we cannot see Him — and He places each of us where we are for a purpose greater than ourselves.

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(Mordeke kab nigus AHishweros qetsiilu kal'ay kone, siITanu nidiHnet kulu hizbu teTegimu. Ester nigisti koyna qetselet — jigninnet'a tarikh'i ziqeyeret sebeyti. Ab metsHaf Ester sim Amlak biqeTta'kwa zeyTiQes aser atsabi'itu ab kulu alo: ab "agatami" zewdi Ester, ab diqas-albo leyti nigus, ab fits'um gize nefsi wekef fits'ame. Amlak kulu gize yiseriH'yu kinri'yo zeynkhil'kwa mis nikewn — ninefsi wekefna kab ri'isna nil'ali nizabeye ilama ab zelonayo bota yeqemTena.)

The Moral of the Story / ቅዱስ ስላሴ

God sovereignly places us in positions and seasons for His divine purposes — nothing in our lives is accidental. True courage is not the absence of fear, but choosing to act faithfully despite being terrified. Standing up for others may cost us everything, yet silence in the face of injustice costs even more. God works powerfully behind the scenes even when His name isn't mentioned and His hand isn't visible.

Our identity and heritage are not burdens to hide but foundations that give us strength and purpose when the moment of testing arrives.

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*(Amlak bil'ul silTanu nimeleketawi ilama'u ab botatat'n gizayat'n yeqemTena
— ab hiyiwetna bi'agatami zikhone neger yelen. Haqenya jigninnet firHi
zeymhilaw aykonen gin bifirHi teshefinka bi'imnet kitgebir mimrats'yu.
Nikh'alot miq'wam kulu kekifhlana yikhil gin ab qidmi ametsi misqaT
zigedede yikhfil. Amlak simu zeyTiqes'n idu zeyir'e'n kwa mis kone bidiHri
medrekh biHayli yiseriH. Mennetna'n wirishana'n kinHab'o zelona tsori
aykonen gin nay fetena himot kibitsiH kelo Hayil'n ilama'n zhibena
meseret'yu.)*

Bible Verse / ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ

"For if you remain silent at this time, relief and deliverance for the Jews will arise from another place, but you and your father's family will perish. And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?" — Esther 4:14

"ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ
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ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ ቅጽጽ?" — ቅጽጽ 4፡14

("Ab'zi gize'zi siq intbelki Hagez'n midiHan'n ni'Ayhud kab kal'e bota kimets'i'yu, niskin beyt abokhin gin kitTef'u ikhum. Nikemzi zi'amesele gize nab'za nigusawit silTan metsi'ikhi tikoni men yifeliT?" — Ester 4:14)

Teen Discussion Questions / 青少年 討論問題

1. Mordecai told Esther that deliverance would come "from another place" if she stayed silent. What does this reveal about God's sovereignty versus human responsibility? Can God accomplish His purposes without us, and if so, why does He choose to use us?

[illegible]

2. Esther had to hide her Jewish identity to survive in the Persian court. Have you ever felt pressure to hide part of who you are — your faith, culture, or values — to fit in? How did that feel, and what did you learn from it?

2. **0000 00 00 000 00-000000 000000 00 0000 0000 00000**
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3. Esther used strategic wisdom — she didn't rush to expose Haman but waited for the right moment through two banquets. How does patience combined with courage differ from impulsive bravery? When in your life might strategic timing matter as much as bold action?

[illegible]

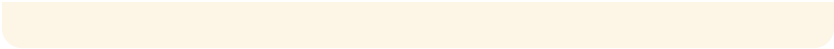
4. The Book of Esther is unique in the Bible because God's name is never directly mentioned. Yet His presence is undeniable in every

Prayer / ማጽናት

Almighty God, thank You for the story of Esther and the reminder that You place us exactly where we need to be for Your purposes. Give us the courage to stand up for what is right, even when it costs us something. Help us to trust that You are always working behind the scenes, even in seasons of silence. Strengthen our identity in You so that when our moment of testing comes, we will not shrink back in fear but step forward in faith. Teach us the wisdom to know when to speak and when to wait, and the boldness to say "If I perish, I perish" when justice demands it. May we never be silent when others are suffering. Use us, Lord, for such a time as this. Amen.

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(Kulu zikhil Amlak, bizanta Ester'n ni'ilamakha ab zedliyena bota bilik'i kem teqemTena bizezekakhir nemesgineka. Qinu'e neger nimgibar waga'kwa zekhfil mis kone kinkewim jigninnet habena. Ab nay siqta gizeyat'wun kulu gize bidiHri medrekh tiseriH kem zelokha kini'amin hagizena. Nay fetena himotna kimets'i kelo bifirHi keyiniHqol gin bi'imnet niqidmit kinisigum ab akha zelona mennet atsini'ana. Me'as kinzareb'n me'as kintsibey'n Tibeb, fitiHi kiHatit kelo "inteTefi'iku Tefi'iku" nimbal difret miharena. Kal'ot kisaqeyu kelewu siq keyinbil. Goyta nikemzi zi'amesele gize teTeqemena. Amen.)



Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 44 of 60

Thank you for reading! We hope this story inspires you to live courageously for God's purposes, trusting that He has placed you exactly where you are for such a time as this.

በዚ ቅጽ ውስጥ የተጻፈው! በዚ ቅጽ ውስጥ የተጻፈው በጥንቃቄ
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Order: dannyshalom.etsy.com | Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com |
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